

▲ Plate 8.4 Roquefort Cheese

and *Pencillium roquefort* gives Camembert and Roquefort cheese. Apart from these products curd, yoghurt, kumiss, leben and kefir are the fermented products obtained from the microbial action of milk.

8.2 Spoilage of Foods

8.2.1 Definition

Food spoilage is defined as decomposition and damage caused to food by various agents making it unfit for consumption.

'Spoilt' is the term used for foods which look harmful and unfit to eat. Spoilt food has an unattractive colour, smell, taste and appearance.

The term 'contamination' means foods which are not fit to be eaten for sanitary reasons. The foods may look good, and taste and smell good, but may contain harmful chemicals, non –food matter and bacteria.

8.2.2 Causes of food spoilage

Foods may be contaminated by air, water, plant, soil, food handler, machinery and equipment, sewage and trucks or carts during transport. Foods get spoilt due to any one or more of the following reasons:



▲ Plate 8.5 Bruised Tomatoes

1. Physical – damage like cuts,bruises
2. Chemical – like the enzymes in the food
3. Biological–changes brought about by the microorganisms and their enzymes.

1. Physical: Physical spoilage is caused by improper temperature, compact stacking which leads to change in the structure of the food.

2. Chemical: The changes brought about by enzymes present in food (intrinsic) or those produced by microorganisms (extrinsic) are of different kinds.

- Oxidising enzymes destroy vitamin C and produce deterioration in flavour.

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